PATRICK MOURATOGLOU: CHAMPION MINDSET

Moderator Guide | Ranger Mastery Program - Day 13

A conversation about purposeful improvement, confidence, and sustainable performance.

Audience: Support Engineers, Rangers, Escalation Engineers, Technical Leads

Suggested duration: 90 minutes | 6-10 participants
Conversation only | No written activities

1. Top learnings and conversation purpose

RMP Day 13 | Week 3: Set boundaries. Explore the application and limits of a coaching perspective through Patrick Mouratoglou's Champion Mindset talk at Talks at Google.

Learning objectives - through conversation, participants will:

Define useful success: connect ambition to customer progress, sound judgment, and teamwork rather than personal ranking.

Focus on influence: distinguish controllable preparation and decisions from outcomes affected by wider conditions.

Build grounded confidence: explore preparation, feedback, and asking for help without pretending to know everything.

Learn from setbacks: consider how to adapt an approach without blaming people or persisting with an unsafe plan.

Protect sustainable performance: discuss recovery, team resources, and boundaries as conditions for dependable work.

Expected outcome

Participants leave with a shared view of high performance as purposeful, supported improvement rather than winning at all costs. They discuss which coaching ideas transfer usefully to support and where customer safety, teamwork, and organizational context require a different approach. There are no written tasks, simulations, worksheets, tests, or required follow-up assignments.

Suggested 90-minute conversation

Time	Conversation topic	Question at its heart
0-8	Welcome, objectives, and opening round	What does performing well mean in support?
8-20	1. Define success beyond being the hero	What does a champion mindset mean in support if the goal is not to beat another person?
20-32	2. Put attention on what can be influenced	When the outcome is uncertain, what can an engineer still influence?
32-44	3. Build confidence that can admit uncertainty	What makes an engineer sound trustworthy when they do not yet know the answer?
44-56	4. Use feedback as coaching, not a verdict	What makes feedback easier to use rather than something to defend against?
56-68	5. Adapt after a setback	When should persistence mean changing the approach rather than trying harder at the same thing?
68-80	6. Keep ambition sustainable and shared	What conditions let people perform well repeatedly rather than rely on occasional heroics?
80-90	Key takeaways and lessons learned	What changed or expanded our thinking?

Use: a flexible route, not a questionnaire to finish. Open with one question and choose follow-ups as needed. Examples are conversation starters, not exercises. The six topics are original support adaptations, not the source's chapter structure.

2. Conversation: success and controllable progress

Topic 1 | Define success beyond being the hero - 8-20 min

Learning objective: Connect ambition to useful customer and team outcomes.

Open the conversation: *"What does a champion mindset mean in support if the goal is not to beat another person?"*

Follow the conversation:

- What can a strong performance look like when a case cannot yet be resolved?
- Which behaviors help the customer but may be less visible than a fast closure?
- Where does a sporting analogy help, and where might it mislead us?

If a concrete example helps: One engineer is praised for closing a case quickly; another prevents a risky change and coordinates the right expertise. Ask: What would a fair view of useful performance recognize in each situation?

If the discussion drifts: *"Instead of ranking engineers, what customer outcome and quality of contribution are we trying to protect?"*

Learning point to draw out: Support success is shared and contextual. Ambition is useful when it improves judgment and customer progress, not when it creates a hero competition.

Topic 2 | Put attention on what can be influenced - 20-32 min

Learning objective: Distinguish purposeful action from trying to control every outcome.

Open the conversation: *"When the outcome is uncertain, what can an engineer still influence?"*

Follow the conversation:

- Which parts of preparation, evidence quality, communication, and escalation are within our role?
- How do dependencies change what a realistic commitment looks like?
- What helps us notice a needed adjustment instead of becoming attached to a result?

If a concrete example helps: Recovery depends on a product team, but the support engineer can clarify impact and assemble reliable evidence. Ask: What useful contribution remains possible without promising an unconfirmed recovery time?

If the discussion drifts: *"Let us separate the result we want from the next contribution we can responsibly make."*

Learning point to draw out: A focus on influence supports action without a false promise of control. Dependencies and limits should remain visible.

3. Conversation: confidence and coaching

Topic 3 | Build confidence that can admit uncertainty - 32-44 min

Learning objective: Explore confidence grounded in preparation, not certainty or status.

Open the conversation: *"What makes an engineer sound trustworthy when they do not yet know the answer?"*

Follow the conversation:

- What preparation helps confidence survive an unfamiliar case?
- How can we communicate an unknown without sounding disengaged or inventing certainty?
- When is asking for help evidence of good judgment rather than weakness?

If a concrete example helps: An engineer takes an unfamiliar issue to a bridge with experienced peers. Ask: What can they state confidently about known facts, open questions, and the help needed without pretending to know the cause?

If the discussion drifts: *"We do not need to perform confidence. What evidence, preparation, and honest next step would earn trust?"*

Learning point to draw out: Grounded confidence includes honest uncertainty and timely help. It does not require projecting expertise beyond the evidence.

Topic 4 | Use feedback as coaching, not a verdict - 44-56 min

Learning objective: Discuss feedback that improves an approach while respecting the person.

Open the conversation: *"What makes feedback easier to use rather than something to defend against?"*

Follow the conversation:

- What difference does a specific observation make compared with a general label?
- How can a coach or peer check what the engineer was trying to achieve?
- What would a useful next adjustment look like without a public performance test?

If a concrete example helps: A peer notices that a case update lists activity but leaves the next decision unclear. Ask: How could feedback focus on its effect on customer understanding and invite the engineer's context?

If the discussion drifts: *"What could the person understand or change from this feedback, rather than what judgment would it express?"*

Learning point to draw out: Useful coaching is specific, contextual, and actionable. Feedback should inform improvement, not rank identity or force public agreement.

4. Conversation: setbacks and sustainable ambition

Topic 5 | Adapt after a setback - 56-68 min

Learning objective: Separate persistence in the purpose from attachment to an ineffective method.

Open the conversation: *"When should persistence mean changing the approach rather than trying harder at the same thing?"*

Follow the conversation:

- What evidence tells us a hypothesis or plan no longer fits?
- How can we acknowledge a mistake without turning it into a judgment of ability?
- What safeguards and decision routes still apply when we want to recover quickly?

If a concrete example helps: Repeated tests do not support the favored explanation, but the team has invested hours in it. Ask: What would show disciplined persistence now: another similar test, a revised hypothesis, or different expertise?

If the discussion drifts: *"What is the evidence asking us to change, and what goal should remain steady?"*

Learning point to draw out: Persistence is not refusing to reconsider. A setback can guide a better strategy while normal safety and change controls remain in place.

Topic 6 | Keep ambition sustainable and shared - 68-80 min

Learning objective: Explore boundaries and team support as part of dependable performance.

Open the conversation: *"What conditions let people perform well repeatedly rather than rely on occasional heroics?"*

Follow the conversation:

- What distinguishes a demanding but supported effort from an expectation of endless availability?
- How do relief, coverage, and accepted handovers protect performance?
- Which conditions require team or leadership action rather than a stronger individual mindset?

If a concrete example helps: An experienced engineer stays late repeatedly because teammates rely on their knowledge. Ask: What coverage, knowledge sharing, or workload decision would reduce that dependency without framing boundaries as a lack of ambition?

If the discussion drifts: *"Rather than ask who wants success most, what work conditions make dependable contribution possible?"*

Learning point to draw out: Sustainable ambition includes recovery, shared capability, and clear limits. Customer care should not depend on one person's willingness to overextend.

5. Moderator's guide: keep it a conversation

Set the tone: opening eight minutes

Introduce the objectives and expected outcome. Say: "This is a conversation, not an assessment. Different roles and regions will see this differently. Use fictional or anonymized work patterns, not customer details. You can pass, and I will make room for each voice."

Use a short opening round: *"When you think of a strong support performance, what stands out: judgment, preparation, teamwork, learning, or an outcome? A short observation is enough."* Invite everyone once, allowing about 20-30 seconds each. Do not solve each case. Name one or two shared themes, then move to Topic 1.

Make participation broad, not forced

Aim for 6-10 participants. With a larger group, use more round tables or allow more time. Rotate the first voice, invite different roles and shifts, and allow silence for thought. Everyone receives a genuine invitation, not an obligation to disclose or defend their ability.

What you notice	A useful moderator phrase
The same people answer first	"Thank you. Before adding more, let us hear from someone who has not spoken on this topic."
A quieter participant has not had space	"Would you like to add a view from your role or shift? Passing is completely fine."
A speaker runs long	"Let me pause there to make room for others. What is the main point you want us to take from that?"
The conversation becomes a detailed case review	"We do not need to decide who performed best. What preparation, coaching, or work condition made useful progress easier?"
A person or region is blamed	"Let us examine work conditions and behaviors, not judge a person or team. What would help any engineer here?"
Participants disagree	"What is each view protecting, and what do we understand differently after hearing both?"
Discussion moves to an unrelated issue	"That matters. Can we connect it to today's question, or leave it for the appropriate channel?"
There is silence	"Take a moment. Would the fictional support example help? What might be difficult in that situation?"

Bridge between topics

Reflect neutrally: "I am hearing [theme], with a different experience around [difference]. Have I understood? That connects to our next question about [next topic]." Do not manufacture agreement. Skip optional follow-ups if time is short rather than rush the closing round.

Boundaries: arrange live-queue coverage and follow normal incident and safety procedures. No customer identifiers, raw logs, credentials, personal health disclosures, or live technical changes. Acknowledge sensitive personal concerns and offer the appropriate private support route; do not investigate them in the round table. Do not turn the sports analogy into competition, toughness testing, or pressure to ignore capacity, recovery, or safeguards.

6. Close: key takeaways and lessons learned

Key takeaways to connect back to the objectives

- Define success through useful customer progress, judgment, and teamwork, not personal ranking.
- Focus on responsible contributions within your influence while making dependencies visible.
- Build confidence through preparation, honest uncertainty, and timely help.
- Use specific feedback and setbacks to adjust the strategy rather than judge a person's ability.
- Treat recovery, coverage, and shared capability as conditions for sustainable performance.

Lessons-learned conversation: minutes 80-87

Invite a brief closing round, with the option to pass: *"What is one idea you are taking away, or one colleague's perspective that changed or expanded your thinking?"* Keep contributions short so everyone has space. No writing or public commitment is required.

If helpful, ask: *"Where might this help in daily support work?"* or *"What still needs team or leadership support?"* Reflect actual participant insights, not anticipated outcomes.

Examples to help the moderator recognize learning

A participant might say...	Connection to the learning objective
"A strong contribution was making the next decision safer, not being the hero."	Purpose: define useful performance beyond visible individual wins.
"I can be confident about the process without claiming to know the cause."	Confidence: connect trust to preparation and honest uncertainty.
"Changing the hypothesis was persistence toward the goal, not giving up."	Adaptation: distinguish commitment to purpose from attachment to a method.

Moderator wrap-up: minutes 87-90

Summarize two or three themes heard, acknowledge differences, and return to the objectives. Do not promise actions you cannot authorize.

Closing thought: *"High performance is not proving that you can carry everything. It is making a useful contribution, learning, and helping the team perform again tomorrow."*

Source and adaptation note

Inspired by Patrick Mouratoglou, Champion Mindset, Talks at Google, assigned for RMP Day 13 (approximately 1h in the program). The public video description was checked November 10, 2026; the talk and its transcript were not reviewed. These six themes, support examples, and questions are original adaptations, not a summary of the book's ten commandments or claims about specific statements in the talk.

RMP program materials | Assigned talk